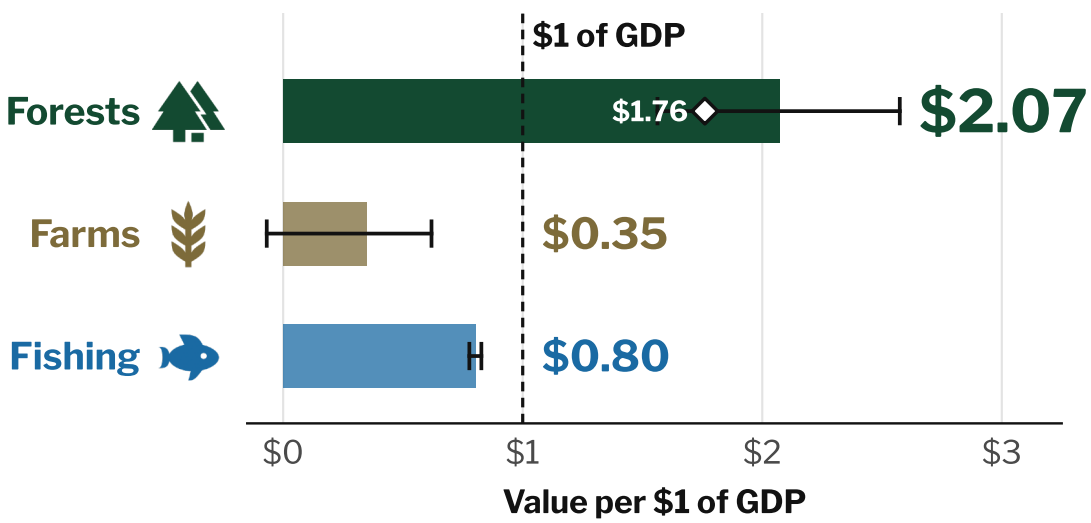
Forests are worth more than markets count, yet get a seventh of farms' research funds

U.S. farms, forests and fishing compared, each counted with its processing industries

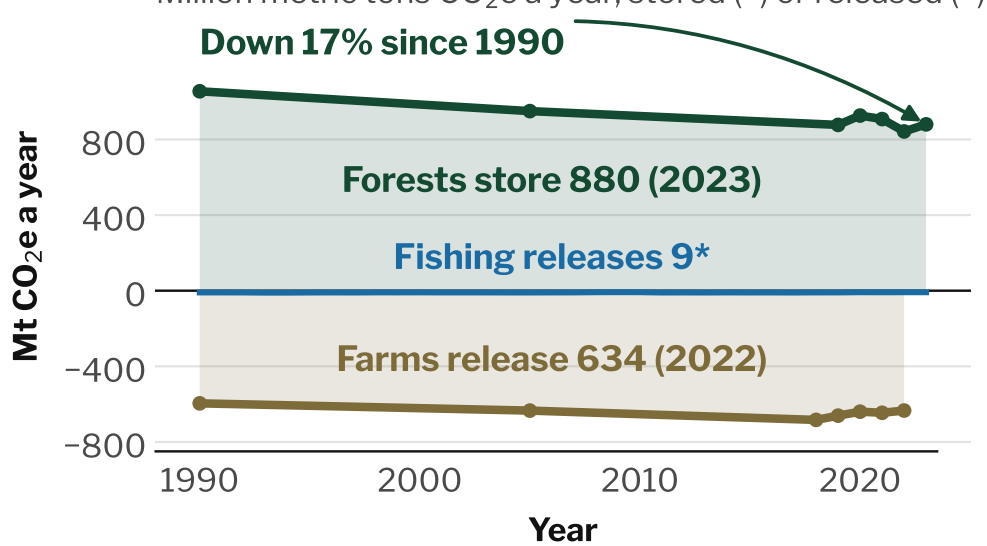
Forests are worth nearly twice their GDP

Counting nature's costs and benefits, per $1 of GDP, 2022



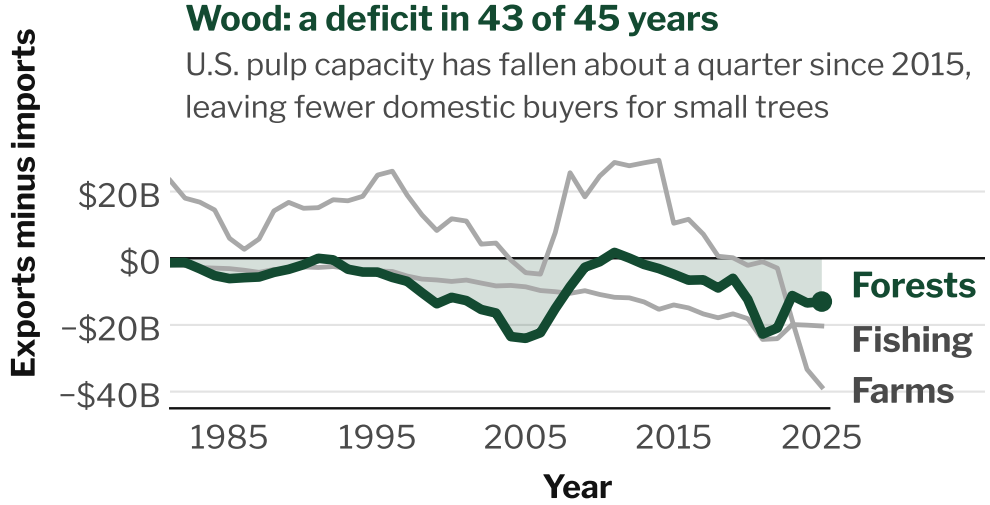
Only forests store more than they release

Million metric tons CO_2e a year, stored (+) or released (−)



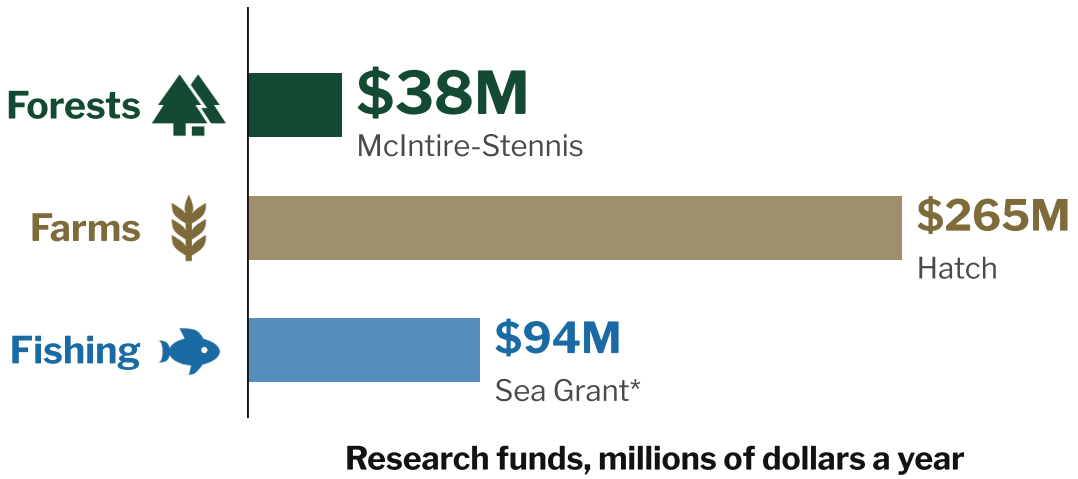
The U.S. buys more wood than it sells

Exports minus imports, billions of dollars a year



Yet forests get a seventh of farm funds

Federal formula funds for university research, 2024



Value per $1 of GDP: GDP less wear and tear, plus carbon at $120 a ton and nature's other costs and benefits, divided by GDP. Black bars: carbon at $51 to $190 a ton. Diamond: forests without the clean air credit. Each sector includes its processing (food, wood and paper, seafood). Clean air value covers all U.S. trees. *Fishing is estimated from landings, and Sea Grant also funds coastal work.

Carbon from EPA, dots mark reported years. Trade: UN Comtrade, nominal dollars.

Data and methods: doi.org/10.5281/zenodo.23122535. Weiskittel, Daigneault and Woodall, University of Maine.